

Football Features for Katogo

Realistic & Doable Implementation Plan — Premier League data, free APIs, highlights video, and engagement features on your existing Laravel stack.

Prepared July 10, 2026 · Budget for data: \$0/month

1. What This Plan Delivers

Katogo already has everything a football section needs: a Laravel API, subscriptions and free trials, Firebase/OneSignal push notifications, a media player, watch history, likes, and a chat backend. This plan adds a complete football experience in **four phases over roughly 8 weeks**, using only free data sources, with every external API cached in your own database so rate limits never touch users.

The core stack (all free): football-data.org for Premier League fixtures, live scores and standings; API-Football's free tier for lineups and match events on big matches; Scorebat's free video API for goal highlights; the official Fantasy Premier League API for player stats; and TheSportsDB for club logos and artwork.

What is deliberately excluded: live Premier League video streaming. No legal free API exists for it, and pirated stream APIs would put your Google Ads account, app store listings, and payment processing at risk. Section 6 covers the legal alternatives, including the one real streaming opportunity: Ugandan football rights.

2. The Free Data Stack

API	What you use it for	Free limits	Notes
football-data.org	PL + 11 competitions: fixtures, results, standings, top scorers, live scores (slightly delayed)	10 requests/min, free forever	Primary source. Register for free key. Attribution required.
API-Football (api-sports.io)	Lineups, match events (goals, cards, subs), H2H — richest data	100 requests/day	Enrichment only: spend the quota on ~3 featured matches per day. Commercial use allowed.
Scorebat Video API	Goal clips + match highlights for PL, UCL, La Liga, Serie A, Bundesliga; embeddable player, near real-time	Free JSON feed	Legally licensed embeds — zero rights negotiation on your side.
FPL official API (fantasy.premierleague.com/api)	Player stats, prices, gameweek data, fantasy features	Free, no key	Unofficial/undocumented. Server-side calls only (CORS blocked). Keep a fallback.
TheSportsDB	Club badges, player photos, stadium images	30 requests/min	One-time scrape → store assets in your own storage/CDN.
ESPN unofficial (site.api.espn.com)	Backup live scores (league code eng.1)	Free, no key	Undocumented; fallback source only.

Golden rule: your users never call these APIs. Laravel scheduled jobs fetch on a fixed cadence, store into MySQL/Redis, and your existing mobile API serves from there. This keeps you inside every free limit even with 100,000+ users.

Key endpoints

```
GET api.football-data.org/v4/competitions/PL/matches (header X-Auth-Token)
GET api.football-data.org/v4/competitions/PL/standings
GET v3.football.api-sports.io/fixtures?league=39&season=2026 (PL = league 39)
GET v3.football.api-sports.io/fixtures/lineups?fixture={id}
GET fantasy.premierleague.com/api/bootstrap-static/
GET scorebat.com/video-api/v3/feed/?token={token}
GET site.api.espn.com/apis/site/v2/sports/soccer/eng.1/scoreboard
```

3. Feature Set — Prioritized for Impact vs. Effort

Phase 1 · Match Center (weeks 1–2)

Feature	How	Effort
Fixtures & results	Sync PL + top leagues 2×/day from football-data.org into fb_matches table	2–3 days
Live scores	Poll every 60–120s only while matches are live; diff against stored score	2 days
League standings	Sync hourly on matchdays; render as native screens	1 day
Follow your team	fb_user_follows table; personalizes fixtures list and later notifications	1–2 days

Phase 2 · Video + Alerts (weeks 3–4)

Feature	How	Effort
Goal highlights tab	Scorebat feed synced every 15 min on matchdays; embed player in a WebView / web player	2–3 days
Goal & full-time push alerts	Score-diff detection triggers your existing Firebase/OneSignal pipeline to followers of either team	2–3 days
Football news feed	Parse BBC Sport, Sky Sports, Guardian RSS every 30 min; show headline + image + link out	1–2 days
Club logos & artwork	One-time TheSportsDB scrape into your storage	1 day

Phase 3 · Engagement Loop (weeks 5–6)

Feature	How	Effort
Score predictions game	Users predict scores pre-kickoff; auto-settle from results; weekly + season leaderboards. Points and non-cash rewards only (keeps you clear of Uganda gaming regulation)	4–5 days
Match chat rooms	One room per big match — direct reuse of your existing chat backend	2–3 days
Polls & Man-of-the-Match votes	Pure Katogo DB feature, no external data	1–2 days
H2H & team form	Last-5 form from your own synced results; H2H from API-Football	1–2 days

Phase 4 · Depth (weeks 7–8)

Feature	How	Effort
Lineups ~1h before kickoff	API-Football, featured matches only (fits 100/day quota)	1–2 days
Live match events timeline	API-Football every 2–3 min for ~3 live featured matches	2 days
FPL companion section	Daily bootstrap-static sync: player prices, points, top picks	3–4 days
Top scorers & player pages	football-data.org scorers endpoint + FPL data	2 days

Later / strategic (not in the 8 weeks): football trivia with reward unlocks, AI-generated match previews, penalty-shootout mini-game, and the standout differentiator — **live VJ audio commentary rooms** in Luganda for big matches (audio-only avoids video rights entirely and is pure Katogo identity).

4. Architecture on Your Existing Stack

External APIs → Laravel Scheduler (cron) → queued Jobs → MySQL + Redis cache → your existing REST API → mobile app. Push notifications fire from the same jobs when a score change is detected. Admin control (featured matches, leagues shown, prediction settlement) goes through laravel-admin, same as your Game module.

Sync cadence (fits inside all free limits)

Data	Frequency	Source
Standings	Hourly on matchdays, daily otherwise	football-data.org
Fixtures (next 7 days)	2× per day	football-data.org
Live scores	Every 60–120s, only while matches are live	football-data.org (ESPN fallback)
Lineups (featured matches)	Once, ~60 min pre-kickoff	API-Football
Match events (featured)	Every 2–3 min while live (~3 matches/day)	API-Football
FPL player data	Daily + after each gameweek	FPL API
Highlights feed	Every 15 min on matchdays	Scorebat
News RSS	Every 30 min	BBC / Sky / Guardian

Suggested tables

fb_leagues · fb_teams · fb_matches · fb_standings · fb_match_events · fb_players · fb_highlights · fb_news · fb_user_follows · fb_predictions · fb_prediction_leaderboard

5. Streaming — What Is Actually Doable

There is no legal free API for live Premier League streams. PL rights in Uganda belong to SuperSport/DStv (with StarTimes holding some other competitions). Every “football live stream API” on RapidAPI or GitHub that serves direct HLS links to PL matches is redistributing pirated feeds.

Do NOT integrate pirated stream APIs: the realistic consequences are Google Ads account termination (you have already handled one compliance issue), removal from app stores, payment processor bans, and rights-holder legal action against the whole Katogo platform.

What you can do instead

Option	Rights situation	Doable?
Scorebat highlight embeds + official YouTube embeds	Licensed on the provider's side	Yes — now, free
“Where to watch” links per fixture (DStv/SuperSport, StarTimes)	Just links; possible affiliate revenue	Yes — now, free
Watch-along rooms: chat + polls + live tracker, users watch on their own service	No video redistributed	Yes — Phase 3
Live VJ audio commentary of big matches	Audio commentary — different rights position than video; validate locally	Yes — strategic
License Ugandan football (UPL, FUFA Big League) and stream via your existing HLS pipeline	Negotiate local rights — far cheaper than PL, digitally underexploited	The real opportunity

Programmable stream URLs for content you DO have rights to

Reuse your movie pipeline: encoder → RTMP ingest (Nginx-RTMP / MediaMTX, or managed: Cloudflare Stream Live, Mux, Dacast) → multi-bitrate HLS (.m3u8) → Laravel issues short-lived signed URLs per user session (e.g. `/live/upl-match-123/index.m3u8?token={JWT, 5 min}`) → validated in middleware/CDN edge → gated by your existing subscription system.

6. Timeline, Cost & Success Metrics

Phase	Weeks	Ships	Running cost
1 — Match Center	1–2	Fixtures, live scores, standings, follow-team	\$0
2 — Video + Alerts	3–4	Goal highlights, push alerts, news, club branding	\$0
3 — Engagement	5–6	Predictions game, match chat, polls, H2H/form	\$0
4 — Depth	7–8	Lineups, events timeline, FPL companion, player stats	\$0
5 — Strategic	later	Ugandan football streaming, VJ audio rooms	Rights + bandwidth

Monetization: keep scores/fixtures free to drive daily opens; put highlights depth, prediction prizes and any sports VOD behind your existing subscription; matchday traffic is prime ad inventory; “where to watch” affiliate links add passive revenue; licensed Ugandan football later becomes a subscription differentiator no competitor has.

Measure: daily active users on matchdays vs. non-matchdays, notification opt-in rate for followed teams, prediction-game weekly participation, and highlight-clip plays per user. If Phase 1–2 lifts matchday DAU, Phases 3–4 are justified.

7. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Free API tiers change or unofficial endpoints (FPL, ESPN) break	Everything cached in your DB; source adapters behind an interface so a swap is a config change
Rate limits exceeded during busy matchdays	Poll only live matches; Redis lock so only one job hits each API; back-off on 429s
Scorebat embeds need online playback	Treat highlights as online-only; your licensed VOD handles offline
Prediction game regulatory exposure	Points + non-cash rewards only; no paid entry, no cash prizes
Temptation to add pirated streams for growth	Hard product rule: video only via licensed embeds or owned rights

Sources: football-data.org · api-football.com · scorebat.com/video-api · thesportsdb.com · fantasy.premierleague.com/api · [Public-ESPN-API \(GitHub\)](https://github.com/Public-ESPN-API) · thestatsapi.com free-API comparison · footyapps.com API guide · football-data.co.uk · [statsbomb/open-data](https://statsbomb.com/open-data). Full details and links: FOOTBALL_FEATURES_RESEARCH_REPORT.md in this folder.